Team Contract Instructions

Your team contract template is divided into three major sections:

1. **Establishing team procedures**
2. **Identifying expectations**
3. **Specifying the consequences for failing to follow these procedures and fulfill these expectations**

Since the **basic purpose of this team contract is to accelerate your team's development, to increase individual accountability for team tasks, and to reduce the possibility for team conflict, make your contract as specific as possible:**

(a) specify each task as detailed as possible,

(b) specify each step in a procedure or process as detailed as possible,

(c) specify the exact person(s) responsible for each specific task,

(d) specify the exact time and exact place for completion or submission of each task. The more specifically you describe your team expectations, roles, and procedures, the greater chance you have for a successful team experience.

Use the Team Contract template to discuss and finalize your team roles, procedures, and standards. Complete, sign, and submit a copy of your finalized contract on Brightspace.

Once your team contract has been developed, your team is ready to begin work on the project. However, you may soon find that your team is not working as well as you had hoped. This is normal but needs to be attended to immediately. Perhaps your team is simply not following the established contract procedures or roles as strictly as it should, or perhaps you need to change some of the procedures or roles as outlined in your contract. Call a team meeting immediately to discuss and resolve the challenges your team is facing; do not delay. Seek guidance from your TA or professor to resolve any conflicts a soon as possible if your team cannot resolve the issues on its own. Do not be afraid to seek help if necessary. The goal is to have the most positive team experience possible.

TEAM CONTRACT

GNG2101, Section # E03

Team Members:

1) Farooq Qureshi
2) Adonai Tshibasu

3) Aly Helal

4) Lhoyd Cabitla

Suggested Projects:
We have unanimously agreed on taking the **One-Handed Switch Controller Project**

Team Procedures

1. Day, time, and place for regular **team meetings**:

   For team meetings, there is no specific time or day. We as a group will communicate when it is best for everyone to have a meeting so that the meetings will include all members. This also ties in with the place for team meetings. For the place of the team meetings, it will vary depending on the situation. It could be in-person on the campus, or it can also be online via Zoom/Google Meets or FaceTime calls. There will be a minimum of one regular team meeting every week but if needed, then there will be more.

2. Preferred method of **communication** (e.g. e-mail, cell phone, Facebook, Blackboard Discussion Board, face-to-face, in a certain class) in order to discuss the project and to inform each other of team meetings, announcement, updates, reminders, problems:

   • Our preferred method of communication is Phone Number Messager. This group chat has already been made.

   • Meeting will be primarily held on facetime and in person if deemed necessary by ALL MEMBERS of the team.

   •All team members will be expected to meet and talk about the upcoming deliverable in person during lab times are on facetime if unable to complete per determined objectives in person.

   • The team will have 2 types of meetings, General meetings, and Subsystem meetings. General meeting will be meant to discuss each deliverable and short-term objectives and will occur either during lab times or on facetime

• Subsystem meetings will have the purpose of allowing individuals working on integrated systems to work and collaborate in an efficient manner to achieve design goals
(Ex: If the 2 mechanical engineers are working on the CAD design for a subsystem agreed upon by the group, there is no need for an electrical engineer to waste his or her time attending the subsystem meeting).

• The team will have one general meeting per week either in person during lab sessions or online on facetime if necessary.

•However, if any member is not satisfied with the attendance and/or contribution of any one on team, the standard procedure is to address the issue IN PERSON during the weekly lab meeting. If a member involved in the conflict is unable to attend the meeting, it will be deemed acceptable to move to a virtual meeting.

• If the meeting about the conflict isn't resolved, the standard procedure is to address the issue to a TA, Project manager, or course professor.

3. **Decision-making policy** (by consensus? by majority vote?):

Our decision-making policy is by consensus. Since we only have 4 people in our group, the majority vote is challenging, therefore if unable to come to a team decision before the end of the week the following procedure will be followed:

During the next lab session, an unbiased explanation of the design choices in question with appropriate context will be presented to all 3 TAs. Once the TA's have heard both decisions, we will have all 3 vote on which decision will be most appropriate to achieve the team's established goals.

Note: Unbiased means that the same person will explain both solutions without using the name of any team member, to avoid making it clear which idea comes from who and before presenting the situation to the TA's. The member responsible for explaining the situation will need to ensure that he has a fair understanding of the proposal of all parties.

4. Method for setting and following meeting **agendas** (Who will set each agenda? When? How will team members be notified/reminded? Who will be responsible for the team following the agenda during a team meeting? What will be done to keep the team on track during a meeting?):

• Adonai will be responsible for coordinating the meetings and informing the team of the key objectives prior to the call via iMessage. This is meant to ensure that all group members are informed of the subjects of discussion and top priorities beforehand.

• He will prepare the agenda at least 24 hours before the meeting. We'll be notified of the agenda via messenger, as well as reflecting the update in Notion too. To keep track during

meetings, we'll go in order of the listed items on the agenda, making sure that the agenda has assigned times to spend on each topic.

5. Method of **record keeping** (Who will be responsible for recording & disseminating minutes? How & when will the minutes be disseminated? Where will all agendas & minutes be kept?):
6.

   Farooq is responsible for keeping the meeting minutes. He will publish a meeting minute document after each meeting within 24 hours. This document will be in the Notion.

Team Expectations

Work Quality

1. **Project standards** (What is a realistic level of quality for team presentations, collaborative writing, individual research, preparation of drafts, peer reviews, etc.?)

A realistic level of quality for this project includes clear and well-organized team presentations that explain the project's goals, design choices, and results in a way that is easy to follow. All written work should be clear, properly formatted, and mostly free of grammar or spelling errors. Individual research should be relevant to the project and the client and also supported with reliable sources if needed. Drafts should be completed on time and show improvement after receiving feedback. Peer reviews should be respectful and helpful, focusing on giving suggestions that improve clarity, accuracy, and the overall quality of the project.

Strategies to fulfill these standards:

To fulfill the project standards, clear roles should be assigned to each group member, so that responsibilities and deadlines are well understood. Shared documents should be used for collaborative writing to maintain consistent formatting and organization. Peer reviews should be used to give constructive feedback. Presentation materials should be prepared early and rehearsed as a group for us to understand all the moving parts, which will help provide clarity and confidence.

Team Participation

1. Strategies to ensure cooperation and equal distribution of tasks:
2.

   We'll ensure cooperation and equal distribution of tasks by rigorously following the Notion chart that keeps us accountable. We'll also stay in constant communication with each other via IMessage and will encourage people to express their concerns about work distributions early on. We'll also adhere to our weekly meetings to make sure that tasks are completed on time and certain people are not doing more than others, in an effective manner.

3. Strategies for encouraging/including ideas from <u>all</u> team members (team maintenance):
4.

We will make sure that ideas are heard by having an allocated section in our meetings for each other to speak about ideas and reflect about how the week has gone GNG 2101 wise between our last date of meeting. This will allow people to communicate their ideas effectively and with low barriers.

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5. Strategies for keeping on task (task maintenance):
6.

We will keep on track by following and constantly updating our Notion chart, allowing us to make sure that tasks are kept track off, and updated. We'll also communicate any changes to our task maintenance via our group chat.

7. Preferences for leadership (informal, formal, individual, shared):
8.

We all adhere to the shared leadership style, at times; it may be the case that some people cannot always agree on the choices at hand. In that case, t**he team will refer to the decision-making policy.**

<u>Personal Accountability</u>

1. Expected individual attendance, punctuality, and participation at all team meetings:
2.

We expect all individuals to attend meetings, and be active participants (ask questions, speak, contribute). We also understand that individuals may not always be available or have the ability to attend or be engaged, in which case we just ask for hindsight from our group members.

3. Expected level of responsibility for fulfilling team assignments, timelines, and deadlines:
4.

We expect all members to fulfill their tasks. In the case where adjustments need to be made, we ask them to communicate this information in a timely manner.

Expected level of communication with other team members:

We expect all individuals to communicate actively in our group chat. Although this may not always be possible, we expect that at the very least individuals are reading the chat and acknowledging what is occurring, and sharing updates where applicable, at least 2-3 times a week.

Expected level of commitment to team decisions and tasks:

All people are expected to contribute to team decisions and tasks. In the case where there is overlapping judgement, the team should refer to the decision-making policy.

Consequences for Failing to Follow Procedures and Fulfill Expectations

1. Describe, as a group, how you would handle **infractions** of any of the obligations of this team contract:

We will try to be lenient at first as some circumstances arise, however if it is a persistent issue, we will first sit as a group and take action by talking to the individual, letting them know what they are doing wrong or could do better, and hope that they fix the infractions.

2. Describe what your team will do **if the infractions continue**:

If what's stated above doesn't work, then we will go to the TA and/or PM, and the final option is addressing the given situation to the professor.

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a) *I participated in formulating the standards, roles, and procedures as stated in this contract.*
b) *I understand that I am obligated to abide by these terms and conditions.*
c) *I understand that if I do not abide by these terms and conditions, I will suffer the consequences as stated in this contract.*

1) Aly Helal **Date**: January 14,2026

2) Lhoyd Cabitla **Date:** January 14, 2026

3) Adonai Tshibasu **Date:** January 14th 2026

4) Farooq Qureshi **Date: January 15th 2026**

* This template was adapted from https://cns.utexas.edu/images/CNS/TIDES/teaching-portal/**Team_Contract**.doc